

SOLANA

DEEP-DIVE RESEARCH SERIES

FILE 2 OF 3

ECOSYSTEM & ECONOMY

[SOL Tokenomics](#) · [DeFi Ecosystem](#) · [NFTs](#) · [Gaming & DePIN](#)

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01 — SOL TOKENOMICS

SOL is the native cryptocurrency of the Solana blockchain. It serves as the fuel that powers every transaction, smart contract, and validator operation on the network. Understanding SOL's supply mechanics, inflation model, and utility is essential to evaluating Solana as both a technology and an investment.

1.1 — Supply & Circulating Supply

Unlike Bitcoin, SOL has **no hard-capped maximum supply**. Instead, it uses a controlled inflationary model designed to incentivise validators and delegators while gradually reducing the rate of new token issuance over time.

SUPPLY METRIC	VALUE (APPROX. 2025)
Total Supply	~583 million SOL
Circulating Supply	~440 million SOL
Staked SOL	~380 million SOL (~65% of circulating)
Annual Inflation Rate	~5% (declining ~15%/year toward 1.5% floor)
Daily New SOL Issued	~50,000-60,000 SOL
SOL Burned (Fees)	50% of all transaction fees
Market Cap (June 2025)	~\$70-80 billion (varies with price)

The absence of a hard supply cap is a common criticism from Bitcoin maximalists. However, Solana's deflationary fee-burn mechanism and declining inflation schedule create a trajectory toward a near-stable supply over the long term. At sufficiently high network usage, fee burns can offset or even exceed new token issuance — making SOL effectively deflationary in practice.

1.2 — Inflation Model & Schedule

Solana's inflation model is one of the most carefully designed in the blockchain space, balancing the need to reward validators with the imperative to preserve token value over time.

YEAR	APPROX. INFLATION RATE	NOTES
2021 (Launch)	~8.0%	Initial rate — highest emission period
2022	~6.8%	15% annual reduction applied
2023	~5.8%	Continued decline

2024	~4.9%	Post-FTX recovery period
2025	~4.2%	Current approximate rate
2030 (Est.)	~2.3%	Approaching long-term floor
Long-term	~1.5%	Terminal inflation rate (floor)

The 15% annual reduction in inflation rate is applied each year automatically by the protocol — no governance vote required. This predictability is a key feature: validators, delegators, and investors can model future token supply with precision. The 1.5% terminal rate was chosen to ensure there is always an incentive to stake and secure the network indefinitely.

The Fee Burn Mechanism

50% of every transaction fee paid on Solana is permanently burned — removed from circulation forever. The other 50% goes to the current block's Leader (validator) as a priority reward.

At peak network usage (e.g., during major NFT mints, memecoin seasons), fee burns can reach tens of thousands of SOL per day — meaningfully offsetting new issuance.

This creates a dynamic where high network activity is directly deflationary for SOL — aligning usage growth with token value.

1.3 — Token Utility

SOL has multiple distinct use cases within the Solana ecosystem, each creating real demand for the token:

USE CASE	DESCRIPTION	DEMAND TYPE
Transaction Fees	Every transaction on Solana requires a small SOL fee	Constant, high frequency
Staking	SOL holders stake tokens to validators to earn ~6-8% APY rewards	Long-term, low frequency
Validator Collateral	Validators must stake SOL to participate in consensus	Locked supply, low frequency
Rent / Storage	Storing data on-chain requires a SOL deposit (rent) proportional to data size	Proportional demand
DeFi Collateral	SOL is the primary collateral asset across Solana DeFi protocols (lending, derivatives)	Protocol demand
NFT & App Fees	NFT minting, gaming transactions, and dApp usage all require SOL fees	Consumer SOL fees
Governance	SOL holders vote on Solana Foundation proposals and ecosystem grant allocations	Periodic demand

1.4 — SOL Price History & Milestones

DATE	PRICE (USD)	KEY EVENT
Mar 2020 (Launch)	~\$0.50	Mainnet Beta launch
Jan 2021	~\$3	First bull market momentum
May 2021	~\$50	First major ATH attempt
Aug 2021	~\$75	NFT boom drives demand
Nov 2021	~\$260	All-Time High (ATH)
Jan 2022	~\$150	Broader crypto correction
May 2022	~\$50	Terra/LUNA collapse contagion
Nov 2022	~\$8	FTX collapse — near-death low
Jan 2023	~\$12	Slow recovery begins
Nov 2023	~\$60	Market recovery + ecosystem growth
Mar 2024	~\$210	New cycle ATH (pre-ETF approval)
Jun 2025	~\$150+	Sustained institutional interest

SOL's price history is one of the most dramatic in cryptocurrency. Its fall from \$260 to \$8 following the FTX collapse — a 97% drawdown from ATH — and subsequent recovery to \$200+ is unmatched as a story of ecosystem resilience. Investors who held through the FTX crisis and accumulated near the lows saw extraordinary returns within 18 months.

1.5 — Staking Rewards Breakdown

Staking SOL is one of the most popular ways for holders to earn passive income. Here is a detailed breakdown of how staking rewards work:

- **Current APY (2025):** Approximately 6-8% annually for delegators, depending on the validator's commission and performance.
- **Epoch-based distribution:** Rewards are distributed at the end of each epoch (~2 days). There is no lock-up period — staked SOL can be unstaked at any time (with a ~2-3 day cooldown).
- **Validator commission:** Validators charge a commission of typically 5-10% on rewards earned by their delegators. A validator with 8% APY and 8% commission would yield ~7.36% net to the delegator.
- **Compounding:** Most wallets (Phantom, Solflare) allow automatic compounding of staking rewards — restaking earned SOL each epoch to accelerate growth.

- **Liquid staking:** Protocols like Marinade Finance and Jito issue liquid staking tokens (mSOL, JitoSOL) that represent staked SOL while remaining usable in DeFi — combining staking yield with DeFi utility.
- **Slashing risk:** Currently minimal on Solana — slashing penalties are conservative and accidental slashing protection is built into the protocol.

02 — DeFi ECOSYSTEM

2.1 — Overview of Solana DeFi

Decentralised Finance (DeFi) refers to financial services — trading, lending, borrowing, derivatives — built on blockchain without centralised intermediaries. Solana's DeFi ecosystem is the third largest by Total Value Locked (TVL) after Ethereum and its Layer 2 ecosystem, representing over \$5 billion in assets as of 2025.

What makes Solana DeFi fundamentally different from Ethereum DeFi is the **speed and cost of execution**. On Ethereum, a complex DeFi transaction (e.g., a multi-hop swap) can cost \$10-\$100+ in gas fees and take 15-30 seconds. On Solana, the same transaction costs fractions of a cent and confirms in under a second. This difference is not cosmetic — it fundamentally changes what DeFi applications are viable to build and use.

METRIC	VALUE (2025)
Total Value Locked (TVL)	\$5+ billion
Active DeFi Protocols	200+
Daily DEX Trading Volume	\$1-3 billion
Largest Protocol by TVL	Jito (liquid staking)
Largest DEX by Volume	Jupiter
Stablecoin Supply on Solana	\$8+ billion (USDC, USDT)

2.2 — Jupiter: The DEX Aggregator

Jupiter (JUP)

DEX Aggregator

Jupiter is the most used DeFi protocol on Solana and one of the most important pieces of infrastructure in the entire ecosystem. It functions as a DEX aggregator — meaning it routes trades across all available decentralised exchanges on Solana simultaneously to find the best possible price for any token swap. Rather than trading on a single exchange like Raydium or Orca, Jupiter splits orders intelligently across multiple liquidity pools to minimise slippage and maximise output. Jupiter processes hundreds of millions of dollars in daily trading volume and has become the primary interface through which most Solana users interact with DeFi. It also offers limit orders, DCA (dollar-cost averaging) automation, perpetual trading, and a launchpad for new token launches. The JUP token, launched in January 2024 via one of the largest airdrops in crypto history, gave governance rights to the protocol's community.

Daily Volume: \$500M-\$2B+ | Protocols Aggregated: 20+ | Token: JUP | Launch: 2021

2.3 — Raydium: AMM & Liquidity

Raydium (RAY)

Automated Market
Maker (AMM)

Raydium is Solana's oldest and most established decentralised exchange, operating as an Automated Market Maker (AMM). Unlike traditional order-book exchanges, AMMs use mathematical formulas (typically $x*y=k$) to price assets based on the ratio of tokens in a liquidity pool. Liquidity providers deposit token pairs into these pools and earn a share of trading fees in return. Raydium was historically unique because it was integrated with the now-defunct Serum order book — meaning its liquidity was shared between AMM pools and a central limit order book. Post-FTX, Raydium migrated to OpenBook and continued as a standalone AMM. It remains a critical source of liquidity for new token launches, memecoins, and long-tail assets on Solana. The RAY token provides governance rights and fee-sharing to stakers.

TVL: \$500M+ | Daily Volume: \$200M+ | Token: RAY | Launch: 2021

2.4 — Marinade Finance: Liquid Staking

Marinade Finance (MNDE)

Liquid Staking
Protocol

Marinade Finance is Solana's leading liquid staking protocol and a critical piece of the network's financial infrastructure. Traditional staking locks SOL in a validator for ~2-3 days minimum — during that time, staked SOL cannot be used in DeFi. Marinade solves this by issuing mSOL (Marinade SOL) — a token that represents staked SOL and accrues staking rewards automatically, while remaining freely tradeable and usable across DeFi protocols. When a user deposits SOL into Marinade, they receive mSOL in return. The mSOL/SOL exchange rate increases over time as staking rewards accrue, meaning holders benefit from staking yield simply by holding mSOL. Crucially, Marinade's staking strategy distributes stake across 100+ validators using an algorithm that optimises for decentralisation — actively working to reduce validator concentration. This makes Marinade not just a financial product but a key contributor to Solana's network health.

TVL: \$1.5B+ | Validators Supported: 100+ | Token: MNDE / mSOL | APY: ~7%

2.5 — Drift Protocol: Perpetuals & Derivatives

Drift Protocol (DRIFT)

Perpetuals &
Derivatives DEX

Drift Protocol is Solana's leading decentralised perpetual futures exchange — allowing traders to take leveraged long or short positions on crypto assets without a centralised intermediary. Perpetual contracts are the most popular trading instrument in crypto, with daily volumes exceeding spot markets on centralised exchanges. Drift brings this market on-chain, with up to 10x leverage, cross-margin accounts, and a sophisticated risk engine. Drift uses a hybrid order matching system combining AMM liquidity with a just-in-time (JIT) auction mechanism that allows market makers to fill orders at better prices than the AMM would provide. This results in tighter spreads and better execution for traders. The protocol also offers spot margin trading, lending, and borrowing. Given Solana's speed (~400ms confirmation), Drift can provide a trading experience approaching that of centralised exchanges.

Daily Volume: \$100M+ | Open Interest: \$300M+ | Token: DRIFT | Max Leverage: 10x

2.6 — TVL History & DeFi Breakdown

PERIOD	TOTAL TVL	KEY DRIVER
Pre-2021	<\$100M	Early bootstrapping phase
Mid 2021	~\$1.5B	First DeFi summer on Solana
Nov 2021	~\$15B	ATH TVL — NFT & DeFi peak
May 2022	~\$4B	Terra collapse market impact
Nov 2022	~\$150M	FTX collapse — ecosystem nadir
Mid 2023	~\$500M	Gradual ecosystem recovery
Jan 2024	~\$2B	Bull market return
Jun 2025	\$5B+	Sustained growth + new protocols

DeFi Category Breakdown (2025)

CATEGORY	APPROX. TVL SHARE	KEY PROTOCOLS
Liquid Staking	~45%	Jito, Marinade, Sanctum
DEX / AMM	~25%	Raydium, Orca, Meteora
Lending/Borrowing	~15%	Kamino, MarginFi, Solend

Derivatives	~10%	Drift, Zeta Markets
Other	~5%	Yield, options, structured products

03 — NFTs ON SOLANA

3.1 — How Solana NFTs Work

NFTs (Non-Fungible Tokens) on Solana are built on the **Metaplex Protocol** — an open-source standard developed specifically for Solana that defines how NFTs are created, stored, and transferred. Understanding the technical foundation explains why Solana became a major NFT platform.

The Metaplex Standard

- **Token Program:** Every Solana NFT is a SPL (Solana Program Library) token with a supply of exactly 1 and 0 decimal places — making it non-fungible by definition.
- **Metadata Account:** Each NFT has an associated on-chain metadata account (created by the Metaplex Token Metadata Program) that stores the NFT's name, symbol, URI (link to image/attributes), and royalty information.
- **Off-chain storage:** The actual image and attribute data is typically stored on Arweave (a permanent decentralised storage network) or IPFS, with only the URI stored on-chain to minimise costs.
- **Compressed NFTs (cNFTs):** In 2023, Metaplex introduced compressed NFTs using ZK-compression — reducing the cost of minting an NFT from ~\$0.012 to ~\$0.000005. This made minting 1 million NFTs cost approximately \$5, enabling mass-scale NFT use cases (gaming items, loyalty points, tickets).
- **Creator royalties:** The Metaplex standard includes on-chain royalty enforcement — a percentage of every secondary sale goes automatically to the original creator. (Note: marketplace enforcement of royalties became controversial in 2022-2023.)

Why Solana NFTs?

Solana emerged as a major NFT platform for simple economic reasons: minting an NFT on Ethereum costs \$50-\$500 in gas fees; on Solana it costs \$0.01-\$0.50. For artists, collectors, and game developers, this difference is the deciding factor. Solana's NFT ecosystem peaked in 2022 and has remained one of the top two NFT blockchains (alongside Ethereum) by trading volume.

3.2 — Magic Eden: The Dominant Marketplace

Magic Eden

NFT Marketplace

Magic Eden is Solana's largest NFT marketplace and one of the most used NFT platforms in all of crypto. Founded in 2021, it grew to capture over 90% of Solana NFT trading volume at its peak. Magic Eden operates as a non-custodial marketplace — sellers list NFTs directly from their wallets and buyers purchase them in a single transaction, with proceeds going immediately to the seller. In 2022-2023, Magic Eden expanded to support Ethereum, Polygon, and Bitcoin Ordinals in addition to Solana — becoming a multi-chain NFT marketplace. This expansion reduced its Solana dominance but significantly increased its total addressable market. Magic Eden's ME token was launched in 2024, rewarding early users and traders with governance rights and fee-sharing. The platform processed billions of dollars in NFT trading volume across its lifetime.

Chains Supported: Solana, ETH, BTC, Polygon | **Token:** ME | **Founded:** 2021 | **Peak Volume:** \$1B+/month

3.3 — Famous Collections

Solana has produced several NFT collections that achieved cultural significance and multi-million dollar floor prices:

COLLECTION	MINT PRICE	PEAK FLOOR	SIGNIFICANCE
DeGods	~3 SOL	~600 SOL	Blue-chip PFP; bridged to ETH; cultural icon of Solana NFTs
y00ts	~375 dust	~200 SOL	DeGods sister collection; migrated to Polygon in 2023
Mad Lads	~6.9 SOL	~400 SOL	Backpack wallet's NFT; technical showcase of xNFT standard
Okay Bears	~1.5 SOL	~100 SOL	Community-driven PFP; one of first Solana blue-chips
Claynosaurz	~2 SOL	~50 SOL	Gaming & animation IP; Netflix partnership
Tensorians	Free	~15 SOL	Tensor marketplace's community NFT
SMB (SolanaMonkeyBusiness)	~0.3 SOL	~200 SOL	First major Solana PFP collection; OG status

3.4 — NFT Volume & Market Share

PERIOD	SOLANA NFT VOLUME	VS. ETHEREUM
Q4 2021	~\$500M	~5% of ETH volume
Q2 2022	~\$1.5B	~20% of ETH volume

Q4 2022	~\$100M	FTX crisis — near collapse
Q1 2023	~\$800M	~40% of ETH volume (ETH also weak)
Q3 2023	~\$300M	~25% of ETH volume
Q1 2024	~\$1.2B	~35% of ETH volume (strong recovery)
2025 (est)	\$500M+ /qtr	Consistent top-2 chain by NFT volume

Solana's NFT market share versus Ethereum has fluctuated dramatically with market cycles and events (particularly the FTX collapse). However, the long-term trend shows Solana consistently capturing 20-40% of total crypto NFT trading volume — establishing it firmly as the number two NFT blockchain, ahead of all other competitors.

04 — GAMING & WEB3 / DePIN

4.1 — Why Solana Is Suited for Gaming

Blockchain gaming requires a very different performance profile from DeFi or NFT trading. Games need to process thousands of micro-transactions per second (item drops, in-game purchases, combat actions), cost almost nothing per transaction (players won't pay \$1 per sword swing), and confirm near-instantly (100ms delays break immersion). Solana is the only major Layer 1 that meets all three criteria simultaneously.

- **Sub-cent transaction costs** make in-game economies viable — players can trade items, claim rewards, and make micropayments without thinking about fees.
- **400ms confirmation times** are fast enough for most game interactions — comparable to acceptable latency in online gaming.
- **Compressed NFTs** enable massive-scale game item economies — a game can mint 10 million unique items for under \$50.
- **Sealevel's parallel execution** means thousands of simultaneous game actions can be processed without queuing.
- **Mobile-first focus** — Solana's developer tooling and the Saga Phone target mobile gaming, the world's largest gaming market.

4.2 — Key Gaming Projects

PROJECT	GENRE	STATUS	HIGHLIGHTS
Star Atlas	Space MMO	In development	AAA-quality Unreal Engine 5 game; \$30M+ raised; own in-game economy
Aurory	RPG / Strategy	Live (beta)	Play-and-earn RPG; cross-platform; own NFT ecosystem
Stepn	Move-to-earn	Live	Walk/run to earn GMT tokens; 3M+ users at peak; genre pioneer
Nyan Heroes	Battle Royale	In development	Cat-themed shooter; Unreal Engine 5; strong early traction
Genopets	Move-to-earn	Live	Mobile RPG rewarding physical activity with NFT evolution
Honeyland	Strategy	Live	Bee-themed resource management with deep on-chain economy

4.3 — DePIN: Decentralised Physical Infrastructure

DePIN (Decentralised Physical Infrastructure Networks) is one of the most exciting emerging sectors in blockchain — using token incentives to crowdsource the building of real-world physical infrastructure. Solana

has become the dominant blockchain for DePIN projects, hosting several of the most successful networks in the category.

Helium (HNT)

Wireless Network

Helium is the world's largest decentralised wireless network, allowing individuals to deploy LoRaWAN and 5G hotspots and earn HNT tokens for providing wireless coverage. Originally its own blockchain, Helium migrated to Solana in 2023 to benefit from lower transaction costs and better tooling. With over 900,000 hotspots deployed globally across 170+ countries, Helium is the most successful DePIN project in existence.

Hotspots: 900,000+ | Countries: 170+ | Token: HNT / IOT / MOBILE | Migration to SOL: 2023

Render Network (RNDR)

GPU Compute

Render Network connects artists and developers who need GPU rendering power with GPU owners who have spare capacity. Rather than paying expensive cloud computing providers, users can render 3D animations, AI models, and visual effects on Render's distributed GPU network at lower cost. GPU providers earn RNDR tokens for their compute contribution. Render also migrated to Solana in 2023, citing lower costs and better developer tooling.

Token: RENDER | Use Case: GPU rendering & AI compute | Migration to SOL: 2023 | Key Users: Studios, AI developers

Hivemapper (HONEY)

Mapping Network

Hivemapper incentivises drivers to mount dashcams on their vehicles and contribute fresh street-level imagery to build a real-time, decentralised alternative to Google Maps. Contributors earn HONEY tokens for mapping coverage. The network has mapped millions of kilometres of roads across dozens of countries. Hivemapper's data is more current than Google's (which updates maps every 1-3 years) because contributors are incentivised to remap roads regularly.

Token: HONEY | Roads Mapped: Millions of km | Countries: 100+ | Camera: Hivemapper Dashcam

05 — KEY PARTNERSHIPS

Solana has secured a number of high-profile partnerships with established companies and institutions that validate the network's production-readiness and expand its real-world adoption. These partnerships span payments, cloud infrastructure, consumer hardware, and financial services.

Visa — USDC Settlement on Solana

In September 2023, **Visa** — the world's largest payment network — announced it was expanding its USDC stablecoin settlement capabilities to the Solana blockchain. Visa had previously piloted USDC settlement on Ethereum, but chose to add Solana due to its significantly faster transaction speeds and lower costs.

- Visa processes cross-border settlement between its treasury partners using USDC on Solana as the settlement rail.
- This marks one of the most significant real-world financial infrastructure deployments on any blockchain.
- The choice of Solana by Visa — over Ethereum or any other chain — was a major validation of Solana's production-grade reliability.
- It demonstrates Solana's viability for institutional-grade, regulated financial applications.

Why This Matters

Visa processes approximately 200 billion transactions per year globally. Even a fraction of that volume moving on-chain would represent transformative usage for Solana.

This partnership validates Solana not as a speculative DeFi playground, but as serious financial infrastructure capable of handling institutional settlement needs.

Google Cloud — Validator & Infrastructure Partner

In October 2022 — notably, just weeks before the FTX collapse — **Google Cloud** announced it was becoming a Solana validator and infrastructure partner. This relationship has multiple dimensions:

- **Validator operation:** Google Cloud runs a Solana validator node, directly contributing to network security and decentralisation.
- **BigQuery integration:** Google Cloud added Solana blockchain data to its BigQuery public datasets, making Solana on-chain data easily accessible to data scientists and researchers using Google's analytics infrastructure.
- **Developer support:** Google Cloud provides infrastructure credits and technical support to Solana developers building on its cloud platform.

- **Node hosting:** Google Cloud offers optimised Solana validator hosting configurations for third-party operators.

Stripe — Payment Integration

Stripe, the dominant online payments infrastructure company (processing hundreds of billions annually), re-entered the crypto space in 2024 after a multi-year absence. Solana was among the first blockchains integrated into Stripe's crypto payment capabilities:

- Stripe enabled USDC payouts to merchants and developers via Solana, leveraging its near-zero fees and instant settlement.
- The Stripe integration allows businesses to receive USDC on Solana as payment for digital goods and services.
- Stripe's developer-first philosophy aligns naturally with Solana's engineering culture, making Solana a natural integration partner.

Solana Mobile — Saga Phone & Chapter 2

In 2022, Solana Labs announced **Solana Mobile** — an ambitious initiative to build crypto-native Android smartphones that deeply integrate the Solana blockchain at the hardware and OS level. The first device, the **Saga Phone**, launched in 2023.

- **Seed Vault:** A secure hardware enclave built into the phone that stores private keys and signs transactions without exposing them to the operating system — eliminating the security risks of software wallets.
- **Mobile Wallet Adapter (MWA):** A protocol that allows any Solana dApp to connect to a phone's native wallet — similar to how WalletConnect works on Ethereum.
- **dApp Store:** A curated Android app store for Solana-native applications, free from Apple and Google's restrictions on crypto apps.
- **Saga Chapter 2:** Following the first Saga phone selling out (driven by an unexpected BONK airdrop that made the phone worth more than its \$599 price), Solana Mobile announced Chapter 2 — a second-generation device with improved specs and an even larger pre-sale than the original.

Jump Crypto — Firedancer Development

Jump Crypto, the blockchain division of Jump Trading (one of the world's largest quantitative trading firms), committed to building the Firedancer validator client — Solana's second independent validator implementation. This is covered in detail in File 3, but it represents one of the most significant institutional commitments to Solana's infrastructure development by any external organisation in blockchain history.

Other Notable Integrations

PARTNER	TYPE	DETAILS
Shopify	E-commerce	Solana Pay integration for merchants to accept SOL/USDC
Brave Browser	Web3 Browser	Native Solana wallet integration in Brave's built-in crypto wallet
Coinbase	Exchange	Deep SOL/ecosystem token listings; Base bridging integration
Circle (USDC)	Stablecoin	USDC natively issued on Solana — one of largest USDC chains
Tether (USDT)	Stablecoin	USDT natively issued on Solana via Wormhole bridge
Deutsche Telekom	Telecom	DT runs a Solana validator as part of its Web3 infrastructure strategy

06 — MAJOR MILESTONES & TIMELINE

The following timeline documents the most significant events in Solana's history — from the original whitepaper concept to its position as a top-five blockchain ecosystem in 2025.

Nov 2017	Whitepaper Published Anatoly Yakovenko publishes the Solana whitepaper introducing Proof of History. Greg Fitzgerald reads it and immediately joins as co-founder.
Jan 2018	Solana Labs Founded Solana Labs officially incorporated in San Francisco. Founding team assembled from Qualcomm, Apple, Intel, and Google alumni.
Q2 2018	Seed Round — \$3.17M Multicoin Capital and Foundation Capital lead Solana's seed funding round, becoming the first institutional believers in the project.
Feb 2019	Testnet Launch Solana's first public testnet goes live, demonstrating 50,000+ TPS in controlled conditions. Developer community begins forming.
Jul 2019	Series A — \$20M Multicoin Capital leads \$20M Series A. Tour de SOL testnet competition launches to stress-test the network with real validators.
Mar 2020	Mainnet Beta Launch Solana's Mainnet Beta goes live. The network processes thousands of TPS from day one with sub-second finality — as promised.
Jun 2020	Solana Foundation Established The Solana Foundation, a non-profit entity based in Zug, Switzerland, is established to support long-term ecosystem development.
Mar 2021	NFT Boom Begins Solana NFTs launch with the Metaplex standard. SolanaMonkeyBusiness (SMB) sells out instantly. SOL price surpasses \$20 for the first time.
Jun 2021	Series B — \$314.15M Andreessen Horowitz (a16z) leads a \$314.15M Series B — the largest blockchain fundraising of its era. SOL surpasses \$40.
Sept 2021	First Major Outage A transaction flood from IDO bots causes a ~17-hour network halt. The event draws widespread criticism but also motivates critical fixes.

Nov 2021	All-Time High — \$260 SOL reaches its all-time high of approximately \$260, making it the 4th largest cryptocurrency by market cap. Ecosystem TVL exceeds \$15B.
Jan 2022	Second Major Outage A 48-hour network degradation caused by an infinite loop bug in the validator client. Stability improvements begin in earnest.
May 2022	Terra/LUNA Contagion The collapse of the Terra/LUNA ecosystem sends shockwaves through crypto. Solana TVL drops from \$8B to \$4B. SOL falls to ~\$40.
Nov 2022	FTX Collapse FTX, Solana's most prominent backer, collapses in one of crypto's largest frauds. SOL drops from ~\$38 to ~\$8. Many predict Solana's end.
Nov 2022	OpenBook Fork Within days of FTX's collapse, independent developers fork Serum into OpenBook — demonstrating the community's determination to rebuild.
Feb 2023	Final Major Outage A ~19-hour network halt caused by a bug in the BPF loader. This becomes the last major outage as subsequent improvements prove effective.
Mar 2023	Helium Migrates to Solana Helium Network, the world's largest decentralised wireless network, migrates its entire blockchain to Solana — a major DePIN milestone.
Sept 2023	Visa USDC Settlement Visa announces Solana as its second blockchain for USDC settlement, validating Solana's institutional-grade capabilities.
Oct 2023	Saga Phone Ships The Solana Saga phone begins shipping to pre-order customers. A surprise BONK token airdrop makes the phone worth more than its \$599 price — causing a sell-out.
Jan 2024	Jupiter JUP Airdrop Jupiter conducts one of crypto's largest airdrops, distributing JUP tokens to 1M+ wallets. Daily active users on Solana hit new records.
Mar 2024	New ATH Cycle — \$210 SOL reaches ~\$210 in the 2024 bull cycle, completing one of the most remarkable recoveries in crypto history from the \$8 FTX low.

Mid 2024	Firedancer Mainnet Begins Jump Crypto's Firedancer client begins its phased mainnet deployment with the Frankendancer hybrid, marking a new era of client diversity.
2025	Ecosystem Maturity Solana enters 2025 with \$5B+ TVL, 2,000+ validators, multiple ETF applications filed, and a developer ecosystem rivalling Ethereum's growth rate.

This concludes File 2 of the Solana Deep-Dive Research Series — prepared by **Nasir Bello**.
File 1 covers Origins & Technology. File 3 covers Analysis & Outlook.